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How Is Psychological Well-Being Shaped in Women's Romantic Relationships?

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Abstract

This research focused on the role of mindfulness in women's romantic relationships. Specifically, mindfulness was considered as a potential process associated with psychological well-being in relation to women's need-related experiences. The sample consisted of 579 women, with a mean age of 30.32 years ($SD = 6.56$). Data were collected using the Satisfaction of Basic Psychological Needs in Romantic Relationships Scale, the Psychological Well-Being Scale, and the Mindfulness Scale. The results indicated that the key variables in the study were positively related to one another. Mindfulness and psychological well-being showed consistent associations with women's need-related experiences. Analysis of the proposed model revealed that psychological well-being varied systematically in relation to women's experiences within romantic relationships. This variation was closely associated with patterns of need-related functioning. The relationship between relational experiences and psychological well-being was attenuated when mindfulness was taken into account. These findings point to mindfulness as an intervening process within the model. Taken together, the findings highlight mindfulness as a meaningful psychological process within women's romantic relationships. Mindfulness appears to be closely linked to women's psychological well-being in connection with their need-related experiences.

Key Words

Basic psychological needs • Mindfulness • Mediation • Psychological well-being • Structural equation model

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Introduction

Psychological Well-Being

Well-being is generally conceptualized as a state in which individuals function optimally both psychologically and experientially. Within the literature, this construct has predominantly been addressed through two complementary yet conceptually distinct orientations: a hedonic approach emphasizing pleasure and positive affect, and a eudaimonic approach focusing on personal growth and the fulfillment of one's inherent capacities (Ryan & Deci, 2001). In a related but analytically different classification, well-being has also been discussed in terms of subjective and psychological dimensions, which, despite their conceptual overlap, diverge in how they frame human functioning and development. From this perspective, psychological well-being extends beyond momentary satisfaction and reflects a multidimensional process through which individuals actively assume responsibility for maintaining and enhancing their psychological integrity and life functioning (Deci & Ryan, 2008; Ryff & Keyes, 1995; Ryff & Singer, 2008).

Ryff (1989) conceptualized psychological well-being as a multifaceted structure consisting of six interrelated dimensions, namely self-acceptance, personal growth, purpose in life, positive relations with others, environmental mastery, and autonomy (Ryff, 1989; Ryff & Keyes, 1995). Within this framework, psychological well-being is conceptualized as an active developmental process rather than a static outcome. Individuals are viewed as actively maintaining and improving their psychological functioning across multiple dimensions, instead of passively experiencing life conditions. Based on this perspective, the literature indicates a strong conceptual alignment between the six dimensions of psychological well-being and the three basic psychological needs defined in Self-Determination Theory. These frameworks intersect in their emphasis on optimal psychological functioning and personal development. In line with the assumption that optimal functioning emerges when basic psychological needs are satisfied, empirical findings have reported meaningful associations between psychological well-being and basic psychological needs (Chang et al., 2015; Deci & Ryan, 1985; Deci & Ryan, 2000; Goulmaris et al., 2014; Jiang et al., 2021; Williams et al., 2000).

Psychological Well-Being and Psychological Needs

Research examining psychological well-being has frequently drawn on the theoretical framework of Self-Determination Theory. Within this perspective, well-being is discussed in relation to individuals' core motivational processes. Within this framework, basic psychological needs are defined in terms of relatedness, competence, and autonomy. Beyond this framework, Glasser's Choice Theory offers a broader motivational perspective by proposing that human behavior is driven by five universal needs, comprising one physiological need and four psychological needs (Glasser, 1965, 1976, 1998; Wubbolding, 2015). Within this model, survival represents the physiological basis of human functioning, encompassing fundamental requirements such as nourishment and reproduction, whereas love/belonging, power, freedom, and fun constitute the core psychological needs shaping interpersonal behavior and self-regulation. Glasser emphasized that psychological functioning and mental health are closely tied to the degree to which these needs are adequately satisfied, arguing that unmet needs are likely to manifest in maladaptive patterns, whereas fulfilled needs foster positive dependencies and adaptive mental health behaviors. Within this framework, psychological well-being functions as a comprehensive marker of mental health. It captures diverse aspects of psychological functioning, ranging from personal development and life purpose to relational quality, environmental mastery, and autonomy.

Supporting this conceptual alignment, empirical evidence has demonstrated that the satisfaction of basic psychological needs serves as a positive predictor of individuals' subjective well-being (Türkdoğan & Duru, 2012).

Ryan and Deci (2000) conceptualized the satisfaction of psychological needs as a dynamic source of vitality that supports individuals' health and overall well-being. From this perspective, healthy psychological functioning is supported when individuals experience sufficient satisfaction of their fundamental psychological needs. Conversely, ongoing deprivation of these needs has been linked to heightened psychological vulnerability and developmental impairment. From a developmental perspective, unmet psychological needs may hinder individuals' capacity for personal growth and self-realization. A comparable emphasis on the centrality of need satisfaction is also evident in Glasser's Choice Theory, which similarly frames basic psychological needs as foundational determinants of personal health, mental health, and well-being.

Psychological Needs and Mindfulness

Glasser emphasized that individuals' awareness of their basic needs plays a critical role in psychological functioning, as such awareness allows them to recognize which needs are more salient and to regulate their behaviors accordingly (Glasser, 1965, 1998). From this perspective, informing individuals about basic psychological needs may serve as a preventive and supportive mechanism for mental health by facilitating more adaptive behavioral choices. Alongside basic psychological needs, mindfulness has also been conceptualized as a key construct associated with mental health and well-being. The literature consistently highlights mindfulness as a process that enhances individuals' awareness of internal experiences and supports psychological functioning, thereby contributing to well-being across diverse populations (Arslan & Asıcı, 2022; Brown & Ryan, 2003; Crego et al., 2020; Gaiswinkler & Unterrainer, 2016; İmroğlu et al., 2021; Klainin-Yobas et al., 2016; MacDonald & Baxter, 2017; Rehman et al., 2023; Whitehead et al., 2019; Zümbül, 2019).

Although mindfulness is often described as being rooted in Buddhist meditation practices, the literature emphasizes that it extends beyond meditation itself and represents a broader mode of conscious awareness. Mindfulness has been conceptualized as an intentional and nonjudgmental engagement with present-moment experiences, reflecting a natural state of consciousness, whereas meditation is regarded as a structured practice that facilitates access to this state (Brown & Ryan, 2003; Kabat-Zinn, 2003, 2005). Empirical evidence derived from mindfulness-based stress reduction programs has consistently demonstrated the effectiveness of mindfulness practices in alleviating both physical and psychological symptoms, thereby supporting its relevance for mental health interventions (Gold et al., 2010; Grossman et al., 2004; Khoury et al., 2015). Beyond its therapeutic applications, mindfulness has also been identified as a construct that supports the satisfaction of individuals' basic psychological needs. Previous studies have reported significant associations between mindfulness and basic psychological needs, suggesting that higher levels of mindfulness are linked to more adaptive need-related functioning (Brown & Ryan, 2003; Chang et al., 2015; Chang et al., 2018; Neufeld et al., 2020; Özyeşil, 2012; Soon et al., 2022).

The Present Study

Previous research focusing on women has examined the effectiveness of mindfulness-based interventions among athletes and individuals with physical conditions, revealing meaningful associations between mindfulness

levels and outcomes such as sleep quality, attentional control, mental health, and physical health (Chang et al., 2021; Matiz et al., 2020; Murphy et al., 2012; Newcombe & Weaver, 2016). In athlete populations, mindfulness practices have further been linked to positive changes in performance-related satisfaction, adaptive stress management, heightened awareness, and positive affectivity (Baltzel & Akhtar, 2014; Goisbault et al., 2022). Beyond mindfulness-focused research, studies examining basic psychological needs have demonstrated that satisfaction of these needs predicts individuals' healthy lifestyle behaviors, irrespective of gender differences in the strength of this relationship, although women tend to report higher levels of healthy lifestyle behaviors compared to men (Shahi-Senobari et al., 2022). Complementary findings have indicated that basic psychological needs and self-efficacy jointly predict psychological well-being, with self-efficacy exerting a significant positive influence on the association between need satisfaction and psychological well-being (Delforouz et al., 2021).

Drawing on existing findings, this study examined mindfulness as a potential intermediary process shaping women's psychological well-being in the context of romantic relationships. The model tested whether mindfulness explained variations in well-being linked to women's experiences of need-related functioning within intimate partnerships. Earlier research has consistently highlighted the close connection between psychological well-being and core motivational processes. In line with this pattern, mindfulness was proposed as a mechanism that may account for this relationship. Research evidence points to a close relationship between mindfulness and psychological well-being within motivational contexts. Increased mindfulness appears to enhance individuals' capacity to recognize both internal states and external resources that support effective self-regulation. In line with these findings, empirical evidence has shown that basic psychological needs may operate as a mediating variable between mindfulness and psychological well-being (Chang et al., 2015). Accordingly, and in accordance with the overall rationale and objectives of the present research, the following research questions were formulated.

1. Is there a correlation among satisfaction of women's basic psychological needs in their romantic relationships, levels of psychological well-being and mindfulness?
2. Does satisfaction of women's basic psychological needs in their romantic relationships predict their psychological well-being?
3. Does satisfaction of women's basic psychological needs in their romantic relationships predict their mindfulness levels?
4. Do women's mindfulness levels predict their psychological well-being?
5. Do women's mindfulness levels mediate between satisfaction of women's basic psychological needs in their romantic relationships and their psychological well-being?

Method

Research Design

This research centered on understanding how mindfulness operates in the context of women's romantic relationships. The analysis explored whether mindfulness serves as a mechanism shaping psychological well-being in relation to women's experiences of core motivational needs. The mediation model was structured around three core components. Experiences related to motivational needs served as the primary explanatory

factor, mindfulness operated as the intermediary process, and psychological well-being was defined as the resulting outcome.

Participants

Participants in the study were women who were currently involved in a romantic relationship or who had previous romantic relationship experience. A total of 579 women participated in the study. The participants' ages ranged from 18 to 64 years ($M = 30.32$, $SD = 6.56$).

Regarding educational attainment, 20 participants (3.4%) had completed high school, 22 (3.8%) held an associate degree, 219 (37.8%) held a bachelor's degree, 199 (34.4%) held a postgraduate degree, and 119 (20.6%) held a doctoral degree.

In terms of relationship duration, 268 participants (46.3%) reported being in a romantic relationship for 1–3 years, 116 (20.0%) for 4–6 years, 74 (12.8%) for 7–9 years, and 121 (20.9%) for 9 years or longer.

Participants were reached through online channels using a non-probability sampling approach. Data collection was carried out using an online questionnaire administered via Google Forms, and participation was based solely on voluntary involvement. Before responding to the survey, individuals were provided with information regarding the purpose of the research, confidentiality principles, and their freedom to discontinue participation at any stage. Only those who provided electronic consent were allowed to proceed with the study.

Research Instruments and Processes

Participants completed self-report instruments targeting key relational, psychological, and awareness-based constructs relevant to the research model. Standardized measures were employed to capture these dimensions. The instruments were used to assess participants' experiences related to relational need functioning, mindfulness, and psychological well-being. Information regarding the measurement properties and structure of each instrument is presented in the sections that follow.

Satisfaction of Basic Psychological Needs in Romantic Relationships Scale

The Satisfaction of Basic Psychological Needs in Romantic Relationships Scale, developed by [Karaman and Arslan \(2023\)](#), was designed to capture individuals' perceived fulfillment of basic psychological needs within the context of romantic relationships. The scale was constructed using data obtained from a sample of 904 young adults and yields both subscale scores—love/belonging, power, freedom, and fun—and a total score representing overall need satisfaction.

Evidence for the factorial validity of the scale was obtained through a two-stage confirmatory factor analytic procedure. Results from the initial CFA indicated an acceptable model fit ($\chi^2/df = 2.32$, $GFI = .91$, $CFI = .96$, $RMSEA = .07$, $SRMR = .05$), and these findings were closely replicated in the second-stage CFA ($\chi^2/df = 2.33$, $GFI = .90$, $CFI = .95$, $RMSEA = .07$, $SRMR = .05$), thereby supporting the proposed factor structure. Additional support for concurrent validity was provided by a strong correlation ($r = .75$) with a conceptually related measure, while item–total correlation coefficients ranged from .49 to .84.

With respect to reliability, the scale demonstrated adequate temporal stability, with a reported test–retest coefficient of .71. Internal consistency estimates were high, with Cronbach's alpha values of .94 for the total

score and between .82 and .93 for the subdimensions. In the current study, the internal consistency coefficient for the total scale was calculated as .95.

Psychological Well-Being Scale

The Psychological Well-Being Scale, originally developed by Diener et al. (2009), is a unidimensional instrument composed of eight items rated on a 7-point Likert-type scale ranging from strong disagreement (1) to strong agreement (7). The original version of the scale demonstrated satisfactory internal consistency, with a reported Cronbach's alpha coefficient of .87.

Evidence for the construct validity of the scale in the Turkish context was provided by Telef (2013), who confirmed its single-factor structure. In the adaptation study, the scale accounted for 42% of the total variance, with factor loadings ranging between .54 and .76. The adequacy of the proposed measurement model was further supported by confirmatory factor analysis results indicating acceptable fit indices (RMSEA = .08, SRMR = .04, GFI = .96, CFI = .95).

Regarding reliability, the Turkish version yielded an internal consistency coefficient of .80. In the present study, the Cronbach's alpha value for the Psychological Well-Being Scale was calculated as .85, indicating adequate reliability for the current sample.

Mindfulness Scale

The Mindfulness Scale, developed by Brown and Ryan (2003), is a unidimensional self-report measure comprising 15 items designed to assess individuals' dispositional mindfulness. Responses are provided on a 6-point Likert-type scale ranging from almost always (1) to almost never (6), with higher scores reflecting greater levels of mindfulness.

Support for the scale's construct validity in the Turkish context was provided by Özyeşil et al. (2011), who confirmed its single-factor structure. Results of the confirmatory factor analysis indicated an acceptable level of model fit ($\chi^2/df = 2.09$, RMSEA = .06, GFI = .93, AGFI = .91). With respect to reliability, the internal consistency coefficient for the Turkish version was reported as .80. In the present study, the Cronbach's alpha value for the Mindfulness Scale was calculated as .84, indicating adequate internal consistency for the current sample.

Data Collection Process

Data were gathered through an online survey administered via Google Forms. Participants were provided with comprehensive information about the research process, including its objectives, voluntary participation, confidentiality principles, and data handling procedures. Access to the online survey was granted only after electronic consent was obtained.

Ethical approval for the research was granted by the Social and Human Sciences Scientific Research Ethics Committee of Necmettin Erbakan University (Approval Date: November 14, 2025; Decision No: 2025/988). All research procedures were carried out in accordance with established ethical standards governing studies involving human participants.

Data Analysis

Initially, Pearson product–moment correlation analyses were performed to explore the associations among satisfaction of basic psychological needs in romantic relationships, mindfulness, and psychological well-being. Following these preliminary analyses, the hypothesized mediation framework was examined using a structural equation modeling (SEM) approach.

The proposed framework distinguished three functional roles within the model. Need-related experiences served as the explanatory component, mindfulness operated as the intermediary mechanism, and psychological well-being was defined as the resulting outcome. The mediation process was evaluated through a sequential modeling strategy. First, the direct path from basic psychological needs to psychological well-being was estimated. Subsequently, mindfulness was incorporated into the model to determine whether it accounted for the relationship between basic psychological needs and psychological well-being.

The indirect effect was assessed using a bootstrapping procedure with confidence intervals, which is considered a robust method for testing mediation effects (Hayes, 2013; Preacher & Hayes, 2004). An indirect effect was interpreted as statistically significant when the corresponding confidence interval excluded zero.

Model adequacy was assessed by examining multiple goodness-of-fit indices, including χ^2/df , CFI, GFI, AGFI, RMSEA, and SRMR, in line with widely accepted evaluation criteria (Browne & Cudeck, 1993; Hu & Bentler, 1999; Kline, 2015; Tabachnick & Fidell, 2015).

Results

Prior to conducting the main analyses, the assumption of normality was evaluated by examining skewness and kurtosis coefficients. The distributions of all variables were found to fall within acceptable limits, with skewness and kurtosis values ranging between -2 and $+2$, indicating no substantial deviation from normality (George & Mallery, 2010).

As an initial analytical step, Pearson product–moment correlation coefficients were calculated to explore the associations among the study variables. The results of these analyses are presented in Table 1.

Table 1

Correlations among variables

Variables	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Love/belonging	1						
Power	.83**	1					
Freedom	.50**	.57**	1				
Fun	.69**	.74**	.51**	1			
Basic Psychological Needs	.90**	.93**	.73**	.87**	1		
Mindfulness	.23**	.23**	.26**	.22**	.28**	1	
Psychological Well-Being	.38**	.34**	.39**	.34**	.42**	.27**	1

** $p < .001$

Inspection of Table 1 shows that the study variables were significantly and positively associated with one another. Following these preliminary findings and in line with the proposed mediation framework, a structural equation modeling approach was implemented using a two-step procedure. In the first step, the baseline model was tested, and the standardized path coefficients obtained from this model are displayed in Figure 1.

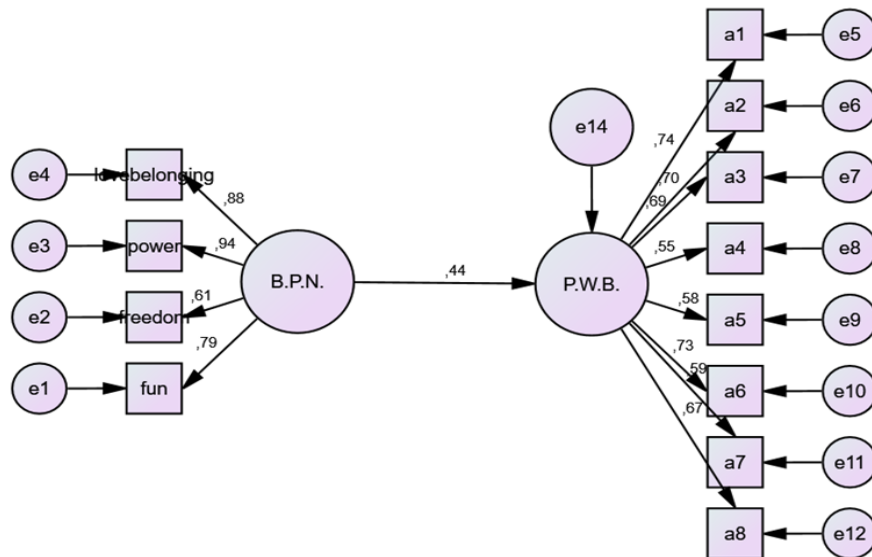


Figure 1. First-step results of structural equation model

As illustrated in Figure 1, satisfaction of basic psychological needs within romantic relationships significantly predicted psychological well-being ($\beta = .44$). Evaluation of model adequacy indicated that the first-step model demonstrated an acceptable level of fit to the data (GFI = .93, CFI = .93, AGFI = .89, RMSEA = .08, SRMR = .06, NFI = .92).

In the second step of the analysis, mindfulness was incorporated into the model to examine its role within the hypothesized mediation framework. The standardized path coefficients for this extended model are presented in Figure 2.

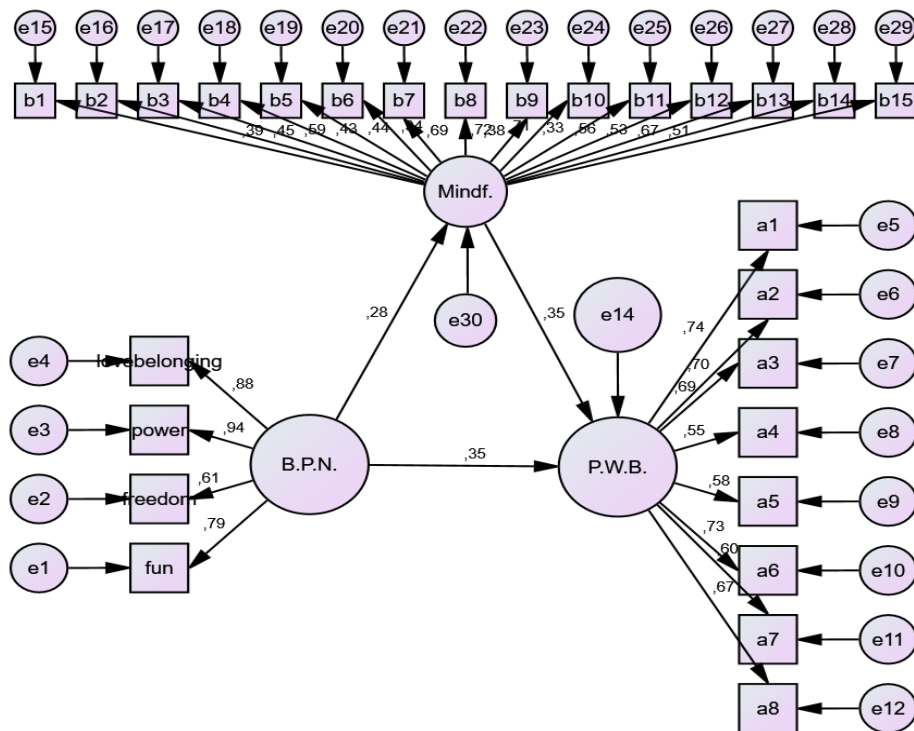


Figure 2. Model testing the mediation of mindfulness

As shown in Figure 2, the inclusion of mindfulness in the model was associated with a reduction in the predictive strength of satisfaction of basic psychological needs on psychological well-being ($\beta = .35$), while the relationship remained statistically significant. This pattern of findings is consistent with partial mediation. Fit indices for the mediation model suggested an acceptable, though comparatively weaker, model fit ($\chi^2/df = 3.33$, GFI = .87, CFI = .87, AGFI = .84, RMSEA = .06, SRMR = .06, NFI = .82).

To further evaluate the mediation process, the significance of the indirect pathway was examined using a bootstrapping procedure with a 95% confidence interval. An indirect association was considered statistically significant when the confidence interval did not include zero. The estimates of direct and indirect pathways are presented in Table 2.

Table 2

Direct and indirect effects

Direct Effects	Standardized Coefficients	Non-standardized Coefficients	p
B.P.N.→Mindf.	.28	.02	.00
B.P.N.→P.W.B.	.35	.08	.00
Mindf.→P.W.B.	.35	.88	.00
Indirect Effect	Standardized Coefficient	Confidence Interval (95%)	
		Lower Limit	Upper Limit
B.P.N.→Mindf. .→P.W.B.	.10	.06	.14

Bootstrapping results indicated that the indirect association between satisfaction of basic psychological needs in romantic relationships and psychological well-being was statistically significant, as the 95% confidence interval did not encompass zero.

Discussion, Conclusion & Suggestions

The findings revealed a coherent pattern linking the key variables examined in the study. How psychological needs were addressed within romantic relationships was reflected in parallel variations in mindfulness and psychological well-being. This pattern of relationships is consistent with a growing body of literature demonstrating that both mindfulness and basic psychological needs are closely linked to indicators of mental health and well-being across diverse populations (Brown & Ryan, 2003; Chang et al., 2015; Chang et al., 2018; Chang et al., 2021; Delforouz et al., 2021; Matiz et al., 2020; Murphy et al., 2012; Neufeld et al., 2020; Newcombe & Weaver, 2016; Özyeşil, 2012; Shahi-Senobari et al., 2022; Soon et al., 2022; Türkdoğan & Duru, 2012).

Analysis of the structural model pointed to a clear linkage between how psychological needs were addressed within romantic relationships and women's psychological well-being. Differences in well-being were observed alongside variations in need-related functioning within relational contexts. This finding aligns with Glasser's theoretical perspective, which emphasizes that the fulfillment of basic needs constitutes a central condition for adaptive mental health behaviors, whereas unmet needs may lead individuals to engage in ineffective or maladaptive strategies, including behaviors that undermine psychological health (Glasser, 1965, 1976, 1998; Wubbolding, 2015). From this viewpoint, romantic relationships represent a particularly salient context for need satisfaction, as close interpersonal bonds play a critical role in meeting individuals' psychological needs. In addition to the presence of intimate relationships, awareness of one's own needs may further facilitate effective

need satisfaction by enabling individuals to identify unmet needs and adjust their behaviors or relational patterns accordingly.

When mindfulness was incorporated into the structural equation model, the predictive strength of basic psychological need satisfaction on psychological well-being was attenuated, indicating a partial mediating effect. This finding suggests that mindfulness constitutes an important psychological mechanism through which satisfaction of basic psychological needs contributes to well-being. Although the direction of mediation differs conceptually, this result is compatible with previous evidence demonstrating the mediating role of basic psychological needs in the relationship between mindfulness and psychological well-being (Chang et al., 2015), highlighting the close interdependence between these constructs.

Analysis of the structural model indicated a significant relationship between need-related experiences and mindfulness levels. Higher levels of mindfulness were observed among individuals reporting more favorable need-related functioning. This result is in line with prior research reporting meaningful associations between mindfulness and basic psychological needs, suggesting that individuals whose needs are more adequately satisfied may display greater present-moment awareness and psychological openness (Brown & Ryan, 2003; Chang et al., 2015; Chang et al., 2018; Neufeld et al., 2020; Özyeşil, 2012; Soon et al., 2022). Consistent with earlier findings, basic psychological needs also emerged as a significant predictor of psychological well-being (Delforouz et al., 2021; Shahi-Senobari et al., 2022). Finally, mindfulness demonstrated a significant positive direct effect on psychological well-being, corroborating extensive evidence linking mindfulness to improved mental health outcomes and higher levels of well-being (Arslan & Asıcı, 2022; Brown & Ryan, 2003; Crego et al., 2020; Gaiswinkler & Unterrainer, 2016; İmroğlu et al., 2021; Klainin-Yobas et al., 2016; MacDonald & Baxter, 2017; Rehman et al., 2023; Whitehead et al., 2019; Zümbül, 2019).

Conclusion, Implications, and Limitations

The results point to the relevance of how women's psychological needs are addressed within romantic relationships. Variations in these need-related dynamics were reflected in differences in women's psychological well-being. From an applied perspective, this result suggests that interventions in psychological counseling, couples therapy, and premarital counseling may benefit from explicitly addressing the extent to which women's basic psychological needs are met within intimate relationships. Beyond direct intervention, enhancing women's awareness of their own psychological needs may facilitate a more informed and functional evaluation of their romantic relationships, thereby supporting healthier relational decision-making. Mindfulness emerged as an intermediate process linking women's experiences within romantic relationships to psychological well-being. The pattern of associations observed in the model supports a partial mediating role of mindfulness. This finding highlights mindfulness as a complementary mechanism that may strengthen the positive effects of need satisfaction on well-being. Accordingly, incorporating mindfulness-based components alongside interventions targeting basic psychological needs may enhance the effectiveness of counseling practices aimed at promoting psychological well-being. Such integrative approaches may enable individuals to better recognize their internal needs and regulate their responses within intimate relationships. The present study has several methodological constraints that should be considered when interpreting the findings. These constraints may limit the scope and generalizability of the results. These limitations need to be acknowledged when interpreting the findings. The educational composition of the sample predominantly consisted of individuals with undergraduate and

postgraduate degrees. This distribution limits the extent to which the findings can be generalized to populations with different educational backgrounds. Data collection was conducted using an online survey format. Responses were obtained through a web-based platform rather than face-to-face procedures. Although this method facilitates access to a broader participant pool, it limits opportunities for participants to seek clarification regarding the research process or questionnaire items, which may have influenced response quality. The results offer meaningful insights despite the methodological constraints of the study. These insights contribute to the existing body of literature by extending understanding of the examined relationships. Future research would benefit from including participants from more diverse sociocultural and socioeconomic backgrounds and from employing alternative data collection methods to strengthen the robustness and generalizability of the results. In addition to these considerations, the findings also have practical implications for professionals working in psychological counseling, couples therapy, and related mental health fields. Practitioners may benefit from systematically assessing women's basic psychological need satisfaction and mindfulness levels within romantic relationships and incorporating targeted strategies to support these processes in intervention programs. Such practice-oriented approaches may contribute to strengthening relational functioning and promoting women's psychological well-being.

Ethical Approval

Approval for the research protocol was granted by the Social and Human Sciences Scientific Research Ethics Committee of Necmettin Erbakan University (Approval Date: November 14, 2025; Decision No: 2025/988).

Author Contributions

The first author was responsible for data collection, literature review, and interpretation of the findings. The second author provided supervision, contributed to the reporting of the study, and participated in the interpretation of the findings. The second author also offered continuous academic mentorship throughout the research process.

Conflict of Interest

The authors report no potential conflicts of interest with respect to the research, authorship, or publication of this study.

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